

INDOOR FARMING

HYDROPONICS

While growing plants without soil or sunlight might seem strange, many large farms do this using a method known as hydroponics. In these indoor environments, the roots of plant seedlings are kept in a solution containing water and nutrients, and special lamps provide heat and light. Hydroponic farms can be constructed anywhere and operate all year round. The most common hydroponic crops are salad vegetables, such as lettuce and tomatoes, and soft fruits.

AQUAPONICS

Aquaponics combines hydroponics with aquaculture (fish farming). Plants are grown in a tank that is home to fish, crustaceans, or mollusks. These animals expel a substance called ammonia in their waste, which is harmful to them but an important nutrient for plants. The plants absorb the ammonia, keeping the water clean.



Plants grown
using hydroponics
need up to
90 percent
less water
than plants in
regular farms.

